Requirements Gathering: Detailed Interview Questions

Project: Disaster Alert & Resource Allocation System

Target Audience: Emergency Operators, Relief Agencies, Citizens · **Format:** In-Depth Qualitative Interview

Section A: Current State of the System

Q1: Alert Issuing & Operational Bottlenecks

How are disaster warnings (floods, fires, earthquakes, storms) currently issued and delivered to citizens, and what are the main operational bottlenecks you face?

Answer: Warnings reach people through limited channels such as TV and word of mouth, and often arrive late. Bottlenecks include no targeting by area or severity, no single channel combining SMS, email and push notifications, and valuable time lost to manual coordination.

Q2: Resource Allocation & Team Coordination

What is the step-by-step process currently used to assign emergency teams, shelters, medical supplies, food and vehicles to affected areas, and how do you track what has been sent?

Answer: Resources are assigned through phone calls and paper lists, so they are often sent to the wrong place or duplicated. Staff cannot see what each shelter or depot holds, records can be lost, and manual counting causes errors and delays.

Section B: Interviewee Opinions

Q3: Alert Speed, Accuracy & Reach

What are the opinions of citizens and emergency operators regarding the speed, accuracy and reach of the current warnings?

Answer: Citizens complain that warnings arrive late or are too general to show whether their area is affected or what to do. Authorities admit the current channels cannot guarantee that everyone is reached, and they support combining SMS, email and push notifications with targeting by area and severity.

Q4: Resource Allocation Efficiency & Visibility

How do stakeholders view the current allocation of resources, and what improvements do they suggest?

Answer: Relief agencies feel supplies are wasted through duplication while other areas go short. Management agrees that a live inventory dashboard, with allocation suggestions based on severity and population of each zone, would make distribution fairer and more accurate.

Section C: Interviewee Feelings

Q5: Stress Points During a Disaster

How do citizens and emergency staff feel emotionally and practically when dealing with warnings and resource management during a crisis?

Answer: Citizens feel fear and anxiety because they lack reliable information about the danger and the nearest shelter. Staff feel overwhelmed trying to distribute limited resources without a clear picture, and fear making mistakes when every minute matters.

Q6: Do you feel the current warnings reach citizens in affected areas in time for them to act?

- ⭕ Yes
- ✅ No

Section D: System Goals

Q7: Core System Objectives

What primary goals must the new web system achieve to transform early warning and resource management for both authorities and citizens?

Answer: Publishing alerts by area and severity through SMS, email and push notifications; keeping a live inventory of resources (ambulances, rescue teams, water, food, medicine, shelter beds); providing a dashboard with maps and reports; and reducing response time while preventing duplicated or missed deliveries.

Q8: Allocation, Smart Alert & Security Features

What features should be included to support accurate alert targeting, resource allocation suggestions, access control and data protection?

Answer: An interactive map showing affected zones, an allocation suggestion engine based on severity and population, integration with weather and seismic data feeds, strict role-based access so only authorized staff can issue alerts, and protection of citizens' personal data such as phone numbers and locations.

Q9: Operations & Readiness During Emergencies

How will the new system help the operations room and relief agencies work efficiently under heavy load and weak networks?

Answer: Through a live view of inventory and unmet needs, instant reports for decision makers, backup storage, and high availability with a lightweight interface that works on weak mobile connections. This reduces manual errors and waste, and supports better decisions during and after an incident.

Q10: Would a multi-channel alert system combined with a live resource inventory significantly reduce response time and wasted relief supplies?

- ✅ Yes
- ⭕ No